MEDORBITS • CAREER RESOURCES

PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION GUIDE

Communicate clearly, respectfully and reliably at work

Practical guidance • Clear steps • Honest representation

Practical guidance for written, verbal and digital workplace communication. Norms vary across teams and cultures, so follow the organization's policies and clarify expectations.

1. Be clear and purposeful

- State the purpose early and include the context the recipient needs.
- Use specific requests, deadlines and next steps where appropriate.
- Keep messages concise without omitting important details.

2. Choose the right channel

- Use email for documented, non-urgent communication when appropriate.
- Use approved chat or collaboration tools according to team norms.
- Use meetings or calls when a discussion needs rapid clarification, then document decisions when useful.

3. Listen and respond

- Let others finish and ask clarifying questions before assuming intent.
- Acknowledge feedback and confirm action items.
- Raise disagreements respectfully and focus on evidence and solutions.

4. Manage commitments

- Respond within agreed timeframes or communicate when you need more time.
- Give early notice of delays and explain the next step.
- Protect confidential information and check recipients before sending.

5. Write professional messages

- Use informative subject lines and a suitable greeting.
- Proofread names, dates, attachments and links.
- Adapt tone to context while remaining respectful.

Key takeaways

- Clarity and reliability build trust.
- Confirm important decisions and next steps.
- Protect confidential information in every channel.

Important: This is general career-development information, not a guarantee of employment or a substitute for employer-specific instructions or qualified legal advice. Verify role-specific and location-specific requirements independently.

MedOrbits • Career resource. Review the employer's instructions and adapt this material to your circumstances.